



Renewed belief: After turbulent spells under Janneke Schopmann and Harendra Singh, coach Sjoerd Marijne has brought some familiarity and much-needed belief, which was previously lacking. GETTY IMAGES



of writing], India has let in 16 goals in five matches — the most it has conceded in a World Cup edition since 2010. Yet, the class of 2026 is a significantly experienced group.

The performances of some of the seniors, including Amit Rohidas and Mandeep Singh, were less than desirable.

Rohidas had an ordinary outing, while Mandeep, who is yet to score, has been on the periphery. Is there a road ahead for them beyond the Asian Games?

Manpreet Singh, approaching the latter half of his 30s, also had a mixed World Cup. Repeated injury concerns for Harmanpreet, who played the second-round matches with a back strain, will also add to Fulton's woes.

With the pressure mounting, Fulton will know that a gold medal at the Asian Games, which will also seal a berth at the 2028 LA